

26:

THE — DUPLICATE PRESENCE

TENDO
MORI
MINABE

VOL.
26

Some doors don't
lead to answers.
They lead to echoes.



A SHADOW HAS
STEPPED INTO
THE RECORD.
IT WEARS HER NAME.



@starfall.archive

EPISODE COVER ART

LISBON
SATURDAY
09:09.

WE SET
FOUR.

THERE ARE
THREE OF
US.

IT'S
09:09.

NINE MINUTES
AHEAD.

OUR PHONES
SAY 09:00.

THE APARTMENT
STABILIZED.

NINE MINUTES
FAST.

THERE
SHOULDN'T
BE—

...

SOMEONE
WAS JUST
SITTING
THERE.

...

REIKA
TENDO
NOTICED.
AFTER.

SLIDE

LISBON,
RUA DA MADALENA, 112

RECEPTION.
11:42

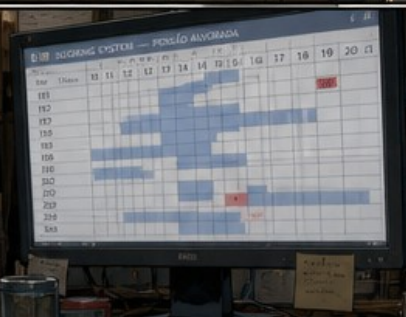
YOU WANT TO SEE
THE ACCOMMODATION
RECORD?

OF COURSE.

JUST... ONE MOMENT.

I'M AFRAID WE STILL
KEEP THE OLD BOOK.

ONLY OUT OF HABIT,
REALLY.



YOUR ROOM,
APARTMENT 204.

THERE'S... NOTHING
HERE. NO STANDARD
BOOKING ENTRY.

JUST SOME
PRIVATE
NOTATIONS.

Nº	DATA	NOME
204	12/06/03	R. Almeida
204	23/09/05	R. Almeida
204	17/04/08	R. Almeida
204	02/11/11	R. Almeida
204	19/03/14	R. Almeida
204	05/03/17	R. Almeida
204	27/07/19	R. Almeida
204	09/01/22	R. Almeida

NOTAS

discreto.	discreto.
L. Almeida	2-3 noites
R. Almeida	janela fechada
R. Almeida	não incomodar.
R. Almeida	pagamento em dinheiro
R. Almeida	mesmo pedido.
R. Almeida	luz da tarde.
R. Almeida	de novo.

THE SAME NAME,
OVER AND OVER.

I CAN'T EXPLAIN
THAT.

THIS ROOM... IT HAS
A LONG MEMORY.

SOME GUESTS
PREFER IT THAT
WAY.

THE INK IS OLD.

BUT THIS LINE...

IT'S
RECENT.

204 R. Almeida
204 R. Almeida
204 R. Almeida
204 R. Almeida
204 R. Almeida
204 R. Almeida

12/05/24 R. Almeida

THIS HANDWRITING...

I'VE SEEN IT
BEFORE.

BUT I CAN'T
PLACE
WHERE.

SHOULD WE...

REPORT
THIS?

NOT YET.

WE NEED MORE
THAN A NAME.

SORA: WORRIED.
KAI: ANALYZING.
REIKA: RECOGNIZING.
MANAGER: GUARDING.

AMOREIRAS.
THE KIND OF PLACE
POSTCARDS PROMISE
YOU CAN TRUST.

TODAY LOOKS
PERFECT.

THAT'S WHY
I DON'T TRUST IT.



SORA
READS THE
WIND LIKE
A LETTER
WRITTEN
BEFORE
TOMORROW.

SOMETIMES
THE WEATHER
IS HONESTER
THAN PEOPLE.



KAI'S PRESENT-TRUTH
FLICKERS AT THE EDGES.

PEOPLE WHERE
THEY AREN'T.
STORIES THAT
DON'T LINE UP.



REIKA SEES
THE WRONG
SHADE.

ALMOST RIGHT.
EXACTLY
WRONG.

SHE TURNS—

AND THE
WOMAN IS
GONE.



UP HERE,
THE VIEW IS
HONEST.

EVERYTHING ELSE
IS HYPOTHESES.



MARQUÊS DE POMBAL
LISBON, PORTUGAL.

12:00PM

AT NOON,
THE ROUNDABOUT
IS BRIGHT AND LOUD.
TRAFFIC, BUSES.
PEDESTRIANS CROSSING
IN WAVES.

TO EVERYONE ELSE,
IT'S CHAOS.
TO US...

...IT'S A DIAGRAM.

KAI: PRESENT-TRUTH

THE PATTERN
ALIGNS.

THE SAME RED CAR.
CIRCLING TWICE.
NEVER LEAVING.

REIKA: MEMORY-SIGHT

A MEMORY
OF ANOTHER
POLITICAL
ERA...

OVERLAID ON
STONE. BRIEF.
COLORLESS.

...THEN
GONE.

SORA: FUTURE-FRAGMENT

WARNING:

IF YOU STAND IN THE SQUARE
TOO LONG...
YOU WILL BEGIN TO BE SEEN
BY SOMEONE WHO IS NOT
PRESENTLY VISIBLE.

NO ONE ELSE
IN THE SQUARE
APPEARS TO
NOTICE THE
TENSION.

IT'S NOT
A ROAD.

IT'S A LOOP.

THE SQUARE
DOESN'T FORGET.
IT OBSERVES.

AVENIDA
DA LIBERDADE.
THE CITY'S PROMISE
IN BROAD DAYLIGHT.

SAFE.
ELEGANT.
CURATED.

BUT THE GLASS
NEVER LIES.



A MOMENT AGO.



A MOMENT LATER.



KAI LEANS IN—

—AND THE REFLECTION
RECOGNIZES HIM
BEFORE HE MOVES.



REIKA NOTICES.

A PASSERBY
REPEATS THE
SAME SMALL
GESTURE.
EXACTLY TWICE.



①



②



SORA SENSES
THE COMING
EVENING—

NOT AS
A FUTURE,

BUT AS
A SEALED
ENVELOPE.



THE STREET REMAINS
BEAUTIFULLY UNCHANGED.

ONLY THE SURFACE
DECIDES TO TELL
THE TRUTH.



JARDIM FERNANDO PESSOA
LISBON, PORTUGAL
LATE MORNING

THE PARK
FEELS
QUIETER
TODAY.

IT HOLDS
THE KIND OF
SILENCE
THAT
REMEMBERS.

SOMEONE
SAT HERE.

WAITING.

FOR A MESSAGE
THAT NEVER
CAME.

THE WEIGHT
OF THAT ABSENCE
IS STILL HERE.
IT CLINGS.

REUNIÃO COMUNITÁRIA
Vamos falar sobre o
futuro do bairro.

SÁBADO

~~10:00~~

11:30

Contamos consigo!
Obrigado!

SOMEONE
CARED ENOUGH
TO CORRECT
THE TIME.

MAYBE THEY
HOPED MORE
PEOPLE WOULD
COME THIS TIME.

THIS PARK...

IT HAS A HABIT

OF MAKING THE
FEAR OF THE
FUTURE FEEL
SMALLER.

MORE
INTIMATE.

LIKE IT'S
ALREADY
FAMILIAR WITH
DISAPPOINTMENT.

AN ORDINARY PARK.

A REPOSITORY
OF MISSED
MEETINGS.

TAGUS RIVERFRONT.
LISBON.
AFTERNOON.

Cais do Sodré
Cacilhas →

TICKETS
Cacilhas
Trajatos
Fluviários

KAI SEES HIS
OWN REFLECTION
A FRACTION LATE.

WOONK

REIKA TOUCHES
THE METAL RAIL
AND RECEIVES A
PAST GLIMPSE—
OF TRAVELERS WHO
WERE NEVER LISTED
IN ANY PUBLIC
RECORD.

SORA WATCHES
THE FERRY MOVE...
AND FEELS THE
FUTURE BLUR INTO
A BLANK BAND OF
WHITE ACROSS
THE RIVER.

BEAUTIFUL, YES.
BUT THE BEAUTY
HAS AN EDGE.
THE RIVER IS
CARRYING MORE
THAN PASSENGERS.

Embarque
Boarding →

BAIRRO ALTO,
after dark.

THE CITY DOESN'T
LOSE YOU.

IT HOLDS YOU.

KAI
TURNS A
CORNER.

THE SAME DOOR.
AGAIN.
FROM A DIFFERENT
ANGLE.

REIKA

HEARS A LAUGH
FROM ABOVE.

—HAHA!

—HAHA!

IT REPEATS.
TOO LATE.
TOO WRONG.

SORA

SEES
A MOMENT
AHEAD.

KAI. REIKA. SORA.
YOU MADE IT.
FINALLY.

THEN—
NOTHING.

EVERYTHING HERE
IS TOO MUCH.

—EXCEPT ANSWERS.

LISBON
19:47

KLIK

...HELLO?

REIKA-CHAN,
IT'S GOOD
TO HEAR
YOUR VOICE.

THE LINE
CONNECTED
IMMEDIATELY.
TOO CLEAN.
TOO FAST.

I HOPE THIS
FINDS YOU WELL.
PLEASE TAKE CARE
OF YOURSELF.
WHEN YOU HAVE TIME,
DO COME VISIT.
AND GIVE MY
CONDOLENCES TO
YOUR FATHER.

...

THE WORDS
WERE POLITE.
PERFECT.
AND THAT'S
EXACTLY WHY
SOMETHING IN HER
WENT COMPLETELY
STILL.

KAI HEARD
EVERYTHING
EXCEPT THE
VOICE.

HE SAW
ENOUGH.

SORA DIDN'T
UNDERSTAND
THE WORDS.

HE UNDERSTOOD
THE IMPACT.

SHE WAS
GOING TO
ASK.

THE QUESTION
SHE'S BEEN
CARRYING
FOR YEARS.

THE LINE
WENT DEAD
BEFORE
SHE COULD.

SILENCE HAS
ITS OWN
ETIQUETTE.



AH, THAT ROOM.
YES, THE YOUNG MAN
WHO COMES NOW AND
THEN.

QUIET FELLOW.
KEEPS TO HIMSELF.
ALWAYS JUST
ONE NIGHT.



NICE POLITE BOY.
PAYS CASH.
NEVER ASKS
FOR ANYTHING.

LEAVES NO
MESS. NOT EVEN
A SCUFF ON
THE FLOOR.



BEEN COMING
FOR YEARS.

EVERY FEW MONTHS.
STAYS ONE NIGHT.
THAT'S ALL.

GOOD BOY.
RESPECTFUL.
LIKE FAMILY,
ALMOST.



HE ISN'T LYING.
HE REMEMBERS
SOMEONE.

SOMEONE REAL.
SOMEONE THE BUILDING
KNOWS.

SOMEONE CLOSE
ENOUGH TO ME
TO BE MISTAKEN
FOR ME.

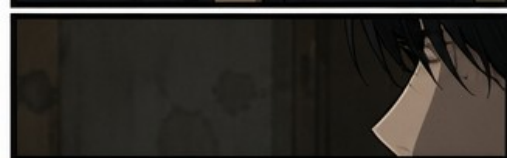


HE SPEAKS LIKE
HE'S TALKING
ABOUT A SON.

OR A GHOST
THAT PAYS RENT.



QUARTO
DISPONÍVEL
DISCRETO
LIMPO
SIGILO TOTAL
PERGUNTAR POR
SR. ALMEIDA



AND THAT MEANS
IT'S BEEN HAPPENING
LONGER THAN I CAN
REMEMBER.



SÃO BENTO.
NEAR PARLIAMENT.

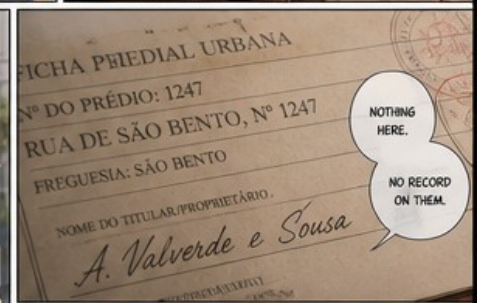


THIS IS
THE ADDRESS.

BUILDING
NUMBER MATCHES.

BUT THIS
NAME—

I DON'T
RECOGNIZE IT.



NOTHING
HERE.

NO RECORD
ON THEM.



IT'S LIKE
THE FUTURE
OF THIS FILE
IS ALREADY
SEALED.

SOMEONE
LOCKED THIS
ROOM.



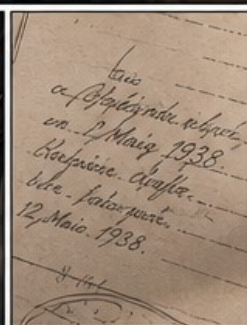
WAIT.

THIS
HANDWRITING—



I'VE SEEN
THIS BEFORE.

IN THE MARGINS
OF OUR FAMILY'S
OLD PAPERS.



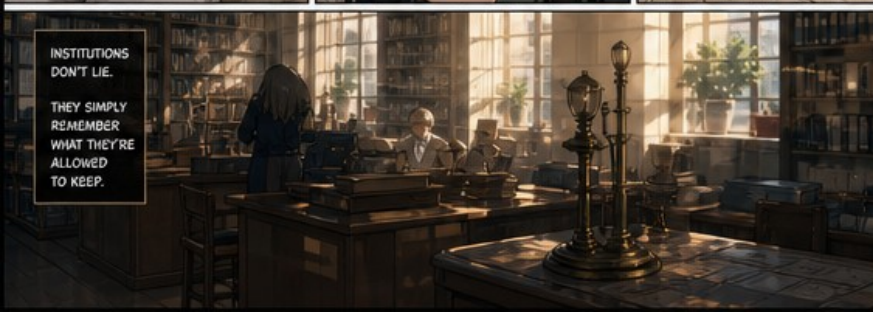
AT A GLANCE,
IT'S ORDERLY.

BUT UNDER
TRUTH-READING...



THE DATES
DON'T LINE UP.

THE STAMPS
ARE OUT OF
SEQUENCE.



INSTITUTIONS
DON'T U.E.

THEY SIMPLY
REMEMBER
WHAT THEY'RE
ALLOWED
TO KEEP.





THE FUTURE...

IT'S NOT
OUT THERE.

IT'S BEEN
PUSHED BACK.

BEHIND
EVERYTHING.



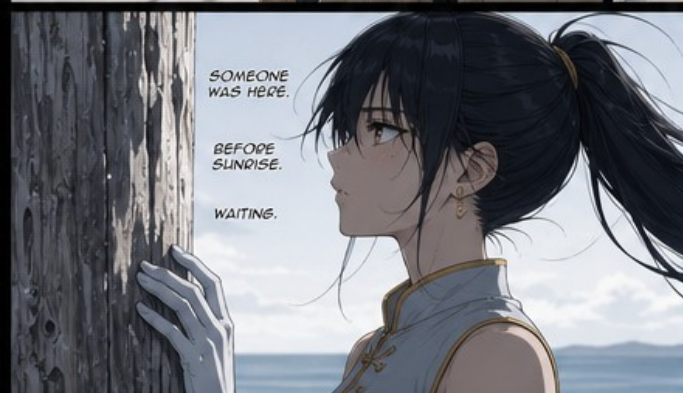
PRESENT
TRUTH.

SOLID.

STABLE.

USELESS.

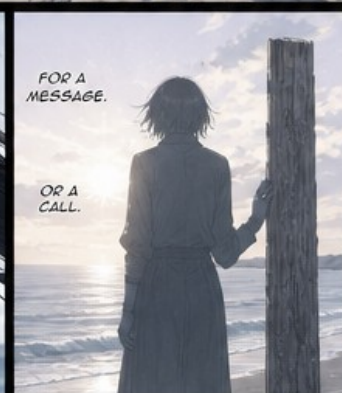
THE SEA
WON'T
ANSWER.



SOMEONE
WAS HERE.

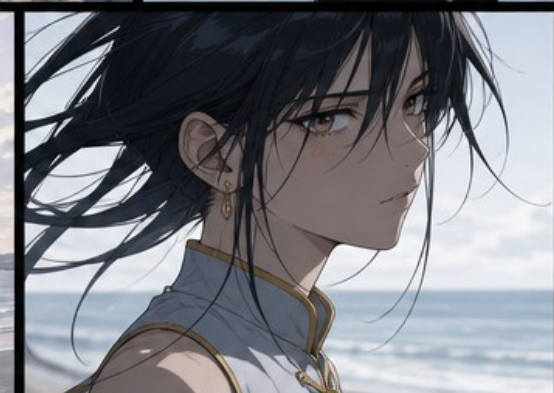
BEFORE
SUNRISE.

WAITING.



FOR A
MESSAGE.

OR A
CALL.



BEAUTY
DOESN'T
EXPLAIN
ANYTHING.



There's another door?
That wasn't in the listing.



Ah...
That one?

It's... been closed for years.



REIKA

*Vision
(Past)*

Door open.
Someone enters
with a notebook.



KAI

*Reading
(Present)*

Repeated
human attention.
Regular
maintenance.
Deliberate
avoidance.



SORA

*Fragment
(Future)*

If we open it—
the apartment
won't be
temporary
lodging
anymore.

...It refuses.

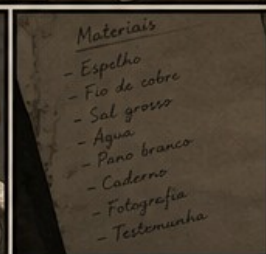
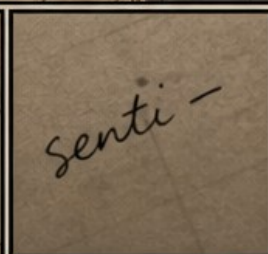
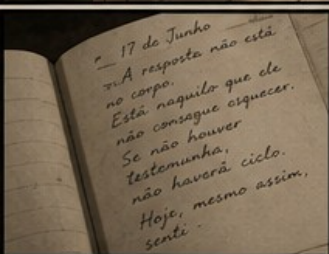


Some doors
aren't locked
for security.

They're locked
because the
building decided
not to be a house
on the maps.



First direct
architectural proof—
the building contains
a second story
of its own.



REIKA RECONHECE
O ESTILO DA ESCRITA.

SÃO BENTO.
O LIVRO DE REGISTOS.

A MESMA MÃO.
A MESMA INTENÇÃO.

KAI SENTE
A PRESENÇA
RECENTE.

A PÁGINA FOI
TOCADA.

O AR AINDA
MEMORIZA.

SORA SENTE
O FUTURO
COMPRIMIR-SE.

COMO SE A SALA
PRENDESSE
A RESPIRAÇÃO
DO QUE AINDA
VAI ACONTECER.

THE LAST
PAGE.

*Lisboa não esquece.
Lisboa pergunta.
Lisboa escolhe.*

Amália

NOT A NOTE.
A SIGNATURE.

A LIVING
IDENTITY.

REIKA SEES.

THIS ROOM
ONCE ASKED
QUESTIONS
THAT HAD
NO SAFE
ANSWERS.

KAI UNDERSTANDS.

THIS APARTMENT
WAS NEVER JUST
ACCOMMODATION.

IT WAS
A DEVICE.

THIS TRIP
HAS CROSSED
FROM TRAVEL
INTO HISTORY.

SOMEONE IN
LISBON ALREADY
KNOWS EXACTLY
WHO THEY ARE.